

Reflection

I chose to select disciplines of history, literature, religion, philosophy, and art to examine the attacks of 9/11 because of the importance of the event that affected all of these disciplines. Limiting the scope of the presentation to just a few of the disciplines would not have done justice to the true interdisciplinary impacts of 9/11. The attacks affected nearly all aspects of daily life in the days immediately after and the years that followed. Shaping many policies that would influence American cultural change. I demonstrated these influences in the presentation by exploring the historical outcomes of the laws and policies enacted following the attacks. Literature was influenced by the attacks and the stories told by authors changed to exploring the emotional responses of the attacks. The attacks brought on philosophical debates of liberty, security and the moral justifications of America's response. Islam and Muslims became targets of prejudice and persecution because the attacks had religious extremist origins causing Islam to be perceived as inherently violent. Artists changed from depicting the historical aspects of the attacks to the emotional responses. Islam was portrayed to Americans through satire and Islamic extremist increased violence against these artists became more ambiguous in their depictions.

My experiences of living in America before the attacks and after allowed me to be better informed on the impacts of the attacks and the effects it had on society and the culture. I can remember the anger that began to rise in both my friends and family towards not just any immigrants or foreigners but targeted at those that immigrated from Muslim countries or had any Muslim heritage. I remember news coverage depicting Muslim countries and their people as an existential enemy of Americans.

I applied several intellectual and practical skills during the creation of this project. It was necessary to use research and analysis skills to evaluate scholarly sources from multiple disciplines and identify how they connected to each other. When organizing the information communication skills were used to create a clear and easy to understand and navigate multimedia presentation. Understanding how the disciplines related to one another and describing that relationship without repetition required problem-solving skills. Technical skills were needed to build the Streamlit web application and deploy for the content to be accessible for audiences.

In my future career in information technology utilizing an interdisciplinary approach will be valuable. IT professionals often encounter challenges that go beyond technical issues. Ethics in technology is the center of many areas of the field including cybersecurity, artificial intelligence, and data privacy. These frequently prompt philosophical conversations involving emerging technology that look at the cultural impacts and historical outcomes. Understanding how these different disciplines contribute to complex problems can improve decision-making and communication with diverse audiences. The importance of examining issues from multiple perspectives was reinforced by this project. It also demonstrated how a liberal arts education can complement technical expertise. I will be better prepared for my career in the information technology field by applying knowledge with cultural and ethical awareness.